03 · Stakeholder Engagement Matrix: writing guide

Owner suggestion: Member 2. **Length:** 2 to 3 pages. **Time:** 20 to 30 minutes, mostly by updating your Term 1 stakeholder analysis.

Purpose

Show that you know **who is affected by or can affect the project**, how much power and interest each has, how engaged they are now, how engaged you need them to be, and **what you actually did or will do** about it. The brief lists "Stakeholder Engagement Matrix" as a final deliverable, so this is the final, updated version of the stakeholder analysis you did in Term 1.

Key ideas explained simply

- **Stakeholder:** any person or group affected by the project or able to influence it.
- **Influence (power):** how much they can change or stop the project.
- **Interest:** how much they care about the outcome.
- **Power/Interest grid (Mendelow):** High power + high interest = *manage closely*; high power + low interest = *keep satisfied*; low power + high interest = *keep informed*; low power + low interest = *monitor*.
- **Engagement levels:** Unaware, Resistant, Neutral, Supportive, Leading. The matrix compares **current** and **desired** level. The gap is the work.

Steps

1. Open your Term 1 stakeholder analysis. List every stakeholder again; add or remove as the project changed.
2. Rate influence and interest (High / Medium / Low) for each.
3. Mark current and desired engagement.
4. For each gap, write a concrete strategy: what, how, how often, who does it.
5. Add one short paragraph summarising the grid and what changed since Term 1.

Stakeholder ideas for CPUTrade *(check each against your Term 1 list, and delete any that do not apply to you)*

Stakeholder	Why they matter in this project
CPUT students (buyers and sellers)	The main users; adoption decides success
Student vendors and outside vendors	Sell on the platform; need approval and support
Local residents	Part of the target community in the brief
Faculty and staff	Possible users; can promote the platform
SRC, student clubs and societies	Can drive adoption and use the bulletin board
Campus security	Meet-up safety and reports of fraud
University IT department	Email domain, hosting, policies
Lecturer / course coordinator	Sponsor and assessor: sets requirements and marks
Project team members	Deliver the work
Service providers (email, hosting, payment gateways, photo sources)	Dependencies for future versions
Competing channels (WhatsApp / Facebook groups)	Users' current alternative; affects adoption

Template to complete

#	Stakeholder	Role / interest	Influence (H/M/L)	Interest (H/M/L)	Grid quadrant	Current engagement	Desired engagement	Engagement strategy (what, how)	Channel and frequency	Owner
1	*Example:* Lecturer	Sponsor and assessor	H	H	Manage closely	Supportive	Leading	Share progress at each sprint review; ask for feedback on the demo	Email + sprint review, every 2 weeks	Member 1
2										

(The example row is only to show the format. Replace it with your own information.)

Short paragraphs to write (2 to 4 sentences each, your words)

1. **Summary of the grid:** who is in each quadrant and why.
2. **What changed since Term 1:** new stakeholders, changes in influence or engagement.

3. **Engagement results:** what you actually did (feedback from students, vendor conversations, lecturer meetings) and what you learned. Even small evidence helps: a survey, a WhatsApp poll, a demo to classmates.
4. **Remaining gaps:** stakeholders you did not reach (for example outside vendors or residents) and your plan.

Common mistakes

- A list of names without ratings, strategies or owners.
- Strategies that are vague ("keep them happy"). Say what, how and how often.
- Forgetting the lecturer, the team itself, or the stakeholders who might *resist* (for example people who prefer WhatsApp).
- Claiming engagement you did not do. Describe honestly what was planned and what happened.

Checklist

- [ ] Every stakeholder has influence, interest, current and desired engagement
- [ ] Every gap has a strategy, channel, frequency and owner
- [ ] Updated from Term 1 and says what changed
- [ ] Includes the lecturer and the team
- [ ] Names match your RACI and contribution page